MAA GANGA COLLEGE OF NURSING

WASHIM, MAHARASHTRA

CODE OF CONDUCT FOR STAFF

Teaching Staff | Clinical Instructors | Non-Teaching & Administrative Staff

Document	Staff Code of Conduct
Applicable to	All employees of the college
Effective from	____ / ____ / _____
Approved by	Principal / Governing Body
Review cycle	Every academic year

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1. Preamble and Purpose

Maa Ganga College of Nursing, Washim, is committed to preparing competent, compassionate and ethical nursing professionals. The quality of nursing education depends on the character, discipline and example set by those who teach, guide and support students every day. This Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour expected from every member of staff, so that the college remains a safe, respectful and academically excellent institution.

The Code is intended to:

- promote a culture of integrity, accountability, dignity and service;
- give staff clear guidance on acceptable and unacceptable behaviour;
- protect the rights, safety and welfare of students, patients, colleagues and the institution;
- ensure compliance with the norms of the Indian Nursing Council, the Maharashtra Nursing Council, the affiliating university and other applicable laws.

2. Scope and Applicability

This Code applies to all teaching staff (Principal, Vice-Principal, Professors, Associate and Assistant Professors, Lecturers, Tutors and Clinical Instructors), administrative and office staff, librarians, laboratory and hostel staff, drivers and support staff, whether permanent, temporary, visiting, contractual or on probation.

It applies on the college campus, in the hostel and transport, in affiliated hospitals and community health field areas, at examinations, during educational visits, conferences and college-organised events, and in any online or digital space where a staff member represents or is identified with the college.

3. Core Values

Every staff member is expected to uphold the following values in all dealings:

Integrity Honesty and fairness in word and action.	**Compassion** Empathy and care towards students and patients.
Respect Dignity for every person, regardless of position or background.	**Accountability** Ownership of duties and their outcomes.
Excellence Continuous improvement in teaching, practice and service.	**Confidentiality** Protection of personal and institutional information.

4. Professional Conduct and Integrity

4.1 General standards

- Perform duties sincerely, diligently and to the best of one's ability, in line with the job description assigned.
- Maintain honesty and transparency in all academic, financial and administrative matters.
- Treat all persons with courtesy, patience and respect; use decent and professional language at all times.
- Follow lawful instructions of the Principal and reporting authorities and the policies of the college.
- Set a personal example of discipline, punctuality, cleanliness and ethical nursing practice.

4.2 Conflict of interest and misconduct

- Do not accept gifts, money, favours or hospitality from students, parents, vendors or agencies that may influence a decision.
- Do not engage in private tuition for the college's own students for payment, or in any outside business or employment that conflicts with college duties, without written permission.
- Do not misuse the name, logo, letterhead, funds, property or facilities of the college for personal gain.
- Do not give false information, forge records, certificates or signatures, or tamper with attendance, marks or inspection documents.
- Do not use or encourage political, communal, caste-based, religious or regional propaganda on campus; staff must keep personal beliefs separate from official duties.
- Disclose promptly to the Principal any relationship or interest that could affect impartiality in admissions, evaluation or purchase decisions.

5. Attendance, Punctuality and Leave

- Staff must report to duty at the notified time and remain on campus or assigned clinical area for the full working hours.
- Attendance must be marked personally through the prescribed register or system. Marking attendance for another person is a serious offence.
- Leave must be applied for in advance in the prescribed form and sanctioned before being availed. In emergencies, the Principal must be informed at the earliest possible time.
- Unauthorised absence, habitual late coming or leaving early without permission will invite action under this Code.
- Classes, practicals and clinical postings must not be left unattended; arrangements for substitution must be approved in advance.
- Staff must not leave the campus during working hours without prior permission.

6. Dress Code and Personal Appearance

As role models for the nursing profession, staff must present a neat, modest and professional appearance.

- **Teaching and administrative staff:** formal, decent attire; identity card to be worn visibly on campus.
- **Nursing faculty and clinical instructors:** prescribed uniform, clean and well-fitted, with name badge, in the clinical area and skill laboratory; closed, comfortable and clean footwear.
- Hair must be tied neatly; nails short and clean; minimal jewellery; no strong perfumes in clinical areas.
- Torn, revealing, offensive or inappropriately casual clothing is not permitted on duty.
- Personal hygiene and grooming must meet infection-control standards at all times.

7. Conduct towards Students

7.1 Teaching and mentoring

- Prepare lesson plans, deliver classes on time and cover the prescribed syllabus and clinical requirements with accuracy.
- Guide students with patience, encourage questions and create a positive and inclusive learning environment.
- Maintain up-to-date records of attendance, internal assessment, clinical competencies and student progress.
- Be available for counselling and academic support during notified hours.

7.2 Fairness and boundaries

- Treat all students equally; there must be no favouritism or discrimination on the basis of gender, religion, caste, community, language, region, disability or economic status.
- Never use humiliating language, physical punishment, threats or mental harassment.
- Maintain strictly professional boundaries; any personal, romantic or exploitative relationship with a student is prohibited.
- Do not ask students for personal work, errands or money, and do not pressure them into any activity outside academic requirements.

8. Conduct towards Colleagues and Administration

- Work as a team, share knowledge and support colleagues, with mutual respect irrespective of designation.
- Resolve differences through discussion and the proper channel; do not quarrel, abuse or make public allegations on campus or on social media.
- Do not spread rumours, backbite or undermine the authority and reputation of a colleague or the institution.
- Report concerns, irregularities or misconduct in good faith to the Principal or the appropriate committee. Complainants and witnesses acting in good faith must not be victimised.
- Participate responsibly in meetings, committees, inspections, accreditation activities and college events, and complete assigned tasks on time.
- Take proper care of college property, equipment, records, laboratory and library resources; losses or damage must be reported immediately.

9. Clinical Area and Patient Care

Nursing education is delivered in hospitals and community settings. Staff who supervise students in these areas represent the college and the profession and must follow the Code of Ethics for Nurses prescribed by the Indian Nursing Council, along with hospital rules.

- Provide safe, respectful, culturally sensitive and non-discriminatory care; the dignity, privacy and consent of every patient must be protected.
- Supervise students directly according to their competency level; never allow them to perform procedures beyond their level without supervision.
- Follow standard operating procedures, medication safety rules and documentation standards, and record accurately and honestly.
- Report any medication error, incident, near miss, needle-stick injury or patient complaint immediately through the proper channel.
- Maintain cordial and professional relations with hospital management, doctors, nursing staff and community leaders.
- Do not accept gratuities from patients or relatives, and never use patient information or images for personal purposes.
- Put patient safety first; escalate concerns without delay.

10. Academic and Examination Responsibilities

- Follow the curriculum, regulations and academic calendar prescribed by the regulatory bodies and the affiliating university.
- Conduct internal assessments, practical examinations and evaluation fairly, objectively and confidentially.
- Maintain the confidentiality of question papers, answer scripts and results; any leak, malpractice or tampering is a grave offence.
- Do not facilitate or tolerate copying, impersonation or any unfair means in examinations.
- Engage in continuing professional development, research and publication, and credit others' work properly; plagiarism is prohibited.

11. Confidentiality and Data Protection

- Treat student records, staff records, financial data, examination material and patient information as confidential.
- Disclose such information only to authorised persons for legitimate purposes and as permitted by law.
- Do not photograph, record or share images of patients, students, answer scripts or college documents without authorisation.
- Protect passwords, login details and official files; do not share credentials or leave records unattended.
- Confidentiality obligations continue after a staff member leaves the institution.

12. Use of Technology and Social Media

- Mobile phones must be kept silent and used only for urgent or official needs during classes, clinical postings and meetings.
- College computers, internet, e-mail and Wi-Fi are for official and academic use; accessing obscene, unlawful or unrelated material is prohibited.
- Staff must not post or forward offensive, defamatory, discriminatory or misleading content about the college, students, colleagues, patients or hospitals.
- Do not publish photographs or videos of students or patients on personal accounts without written permission.
- Official communication with students and parents must be through approved channels and in a professional tone.
- Personal opinions shared online must not be presented as the views of the college. Staff must not use the college name or logo on personal pages without permission.

13. Safe and Respectful Campus

13.1 Prevention of sexual harassment

The college has zero tolerance for sexual harassment. In accordance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, an Internal Committee is constituted to receive and inquire into complaints. Unwelcome physical contact, advances, remarks, jokes, messages, gestures, display of pornography or any other unwelcome conduct of a sexual nature is strictly prohibited towards any student, colleague, patient or visitor.

13.2 Anti-ragging and anti-bullying

Ragging in any form is prohibited under the UGC and regulatory body regulations and applicable law. Staff must not participate in, encourage or ignore ragging or bullying, and must immediately report any incident to the Principal or the Anti-Ragging Committee.

13.3 Non-discrimination

Discrimination, intimidation or abuse on grounds of gender, caste, religion, language, region, disability or social background is not permitted, in line with the Constitution of India and the laws for the protection of persons from discrimination.

14. Health, Safety and Infection Control

- Follow standard precautions, hand hygiene, personal protective equipment use and bio-medical waste segregation as prescribed.
- Keep classrooms, laboratories, library, hostel and campus clean; notify hazards, fire risks and unsafe conditions immediately.
- Know the location and use of fire-fighting equipment, first-aid kits and the emergency exit plan; take part in mock drills.
- Report to work in a fit state. The use of tobacco, alcohol, gutkha or any intoxicating or illegal substance on campus or in clinical areas, or reporting for duty under their influence, is strictly prohibited.
- Carrying weapons, or any article that may endanger the safety of others, is not allowed on campus.
- Staff should maintain their own health and immunisation status as advised for healthcare workers, and report any communicable illness to the Principal.
- In emergencies, the safety and care of students, patients and visitors take priority.

15. Disciplinary Procedure and Grievance Redressal

15.1 Violations

Violation of this Code may amount to misconduct. Depending on gravity, repetition and circumstances, the following action may be taken after due process:

- verbal counselling or advice;
- written warning or memorandum;
- recorded censure and withholding of increment or promotion;
- suspension pending inquiry;
- recovery of loss caused to the institution;
- termination of service; and/or reporting to the Nursing Council, police or other authority where the law requires.

15.2 Principles of fair procedure

- The staff member will be informed in writing of the allegation and given a fair opportunity to submit an explanation.
- Serious matters will be examined by an inquiry committee appointed by the Principal or the management; the staff member may present evidence and may be accompanied by a colleague.
- Decisions will be based on facts and recorded in writing, and will be communicated to the staff member.
- Complaints related to sexual harassment will be dealt with only by the Internal Committee under the 2013 Act.

15.3 Grievance redressal

Any staff member with a work-related grievance may first approach the Head of Department or the immediate reporting officer, then the Principal in writing. If unresolved, the matter may be placed before the Grievance Redressal Committee of the college or the management. Grievances will be handled confidentially, promptly and without retaliation.

16. Review, Amendment and Declaration

This Code will be reviewed every academic year, or sooner when required by changes in law, regulatory norms or institutional policy. The Principal, with the approval of the management, may amend, add to or withdraw any provision and will notify all staff in writing. Matters not covered by this Code will be decided by the Principal in the spirit of its principles.

A copy of this Code will be given to every staff member at the time of appointment and displayed in the staff room. Ignorance of the Code will not be accepted as a defence.

Key Do's and Don'ts at a glance

DO	DON'T
• Be punctual and prepared • Respect students, patients and colleagues • Protect confidentiality • Wear uniform / ID card • Report incidents promptly • Maintain professional boundaries • Follow infection-control practices	• Mark proxy attendance • Accept gifts or favours • Misuse college name or property • Harass, bully or discriminate • Share patient or student photos • Use phones in class or clinical area • Come to duty under the influence of intoxicants

Important contacts (to be filled in by the college)

Principal	
Internal Committee (POSH) Presiding Officer	
Anti-Ragging Committee Convener	
Grievance Redressal Committee Convener	

Staff Declaration and Acknowledgement

I, the undersigned, hereby declare that:

- I have received, read and understood the Code of Conduct for Staff of Maa Ganga College of Nursing, Washim.
- I agree to abide by all its provisions, along with the rules and policies of the college and the regulations of the Indian Nursing Council, the Maharashtra Nursing Council and the affiliating university.
- I understand that violation of this Code may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of service.
- I will maintain the confidentiality of information that I come across during my service, including after it ends.
- I will report any breach of this Code that comes to my notice, in good faith, to the competent authority.

Name of staff member	
Designation / Department	
Employee ID (if any)	
Date of joining	
Signature	
Date and place	

For office use

Received by (name and signature)	
Date of receipt	

Signature of Principal
(with college seal)